Nilesh Shinde

O'Neill School of Public and Environmental Affairs, Indiana University Bloomington

nshinde@iu.edu | sites.google.com/view/nshinde

Academic Appointments

Assistant Professor, O'Neill School, Indiana University Bloomington 2025–

Postdoctoral Research Associate, Resource Economics, UMass Amherst 2022–2025

Education

Ph.D., Economics & Informatics, USA

M.Sc., Development Economics, Brazil

B.E., Mechanical Engineering, India

Publications

1. ''Land registration and conflict reduction: Evidence from the Brazilian Amazon" (with S. Schons, A. Gori Maia, and G. Amacher). *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*, Volume 141, January 2027, 103432
2. "Primary Care, Weather, and the Missed Opportunity for Savings" (with M. Yoder, G. Chi, S. Freedman, K. Simon, and S. Angell). *Health Affairs Scholar*, 4(9): qxag225, 2026.
3. "The Cold, Hard Truth: Heterogeneous Snowpack Insulation Effects on Winter Wheat Yields in China" (with Z. Yao). *Environment and Development Economics*, 1–24, 2025.
4. "Beyond the Canopy: How Satellite Data Resolution Influences Policy Evaluation and Deforestation Behavior" (with K. Baragwanath). *Journal of Environmental Economics and Management*, 134: 103219, 2025.
5. "The Human Well-Being Potential of Tree Plantations in Sub-Saharan Africa" (with E. Mensah, A. Kakpo, and I. Djenontin). *Forest Policy and Economics*, 160: 103141, 2024.
6. "Collective Property Rights Lead to Secondary Forest Growth in the Brazilian Amazon" (with K. Baragwanath and E. Bayi). *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 120(22): e2221346120, 2023.
7. "Incentives for Rural Households to Establish Tree Cover on Agricultural Land in Andhra Pradesh, India" (with S. Schons, G. Amacher, K. Cobourn, and H. Gundimeda). In *Environmental Economics in Developing Countries*, Routledge, 2022.

Working Papers

8. "Gross External Damages of Water Pollution in the United States" (with D. Keiser, D. Phaneuf, C. Kling, Y. Ji, T. Andarge, M. Hoque, and Y.-H. Shr). NBER Working Paper. Under review.
9. "Divide and Deforest: The Perverse Incentives of Land Regularization in the Brazilian Amazon" (with K. Baragwanath). Ronald Coase Institute Working Paper. Under review.
10. "Unintended Consequences of a Large Irrigation Project for Groundwater Recharge" (with P. Gajbhiye and M. Woerman). Revise and resubmit at *Journal of Development Economics*.
11. "Addressing the Threat of Groundwater Depletion: Does a Command-and-Control Approach Work?" (with J. Paudel and S. Upadhyay). Revise and resubmit at *World Development*.
12. "Thirteenth Month of a Drought Year: Agricultural Shocks and Judicial Outcomes in India" (with S. Sarkar). Under review.

13. "Forest Disease, Wildfire Risk, and Recreational Welfare: Evidence from the USA" (with C. Bryan). Under review.
14. "Improving Environmental Outcomes Through Investments in Local Governance: Evidence from Brazil" (with S. Schons, K. Baragwanath, A. Gori Maia, and G. Amacher). Under review.
15. "Compliance Persistence and Conservation Permanence on Private Land in the Brazilian Amazon" (with S. Schons, A. Gori Maia, and G. Amacher). Under review.
16. "Disease at the Root, Deforestation at the Edge: Cassava Epidemic and Deforestation in Uganda" (with N. Deopa). Under review.
17. "Drought-Induced Deforestation in the Brazilian Amazon" (with T. Gong, A. Goswami, and M. Osman). Under review.
18. "Hazardous Waste Sites Alter Regional Soil Chemistry: Evidence from 80,000 Soil Tests in Tennessee" (with S. Sarkar). Under review.
19. "The Agrarian Cost of Groundwater Depletion in India" (with P. Gajbhiye and M. Woerman). Under review.

Grants and Awards

CLACS Faculty Research Grant ($3,500); FADS ($5,500)	2026–27
Ronald Coase Institute Grant, Divide and Deforest; $20,000	2025
MapBiomas Award (5th ed.)	2023
USDA Travel Grant; $5,000	2022–24
ICTAS Doctoral Research Grant, Virginia Tech; $136,000	2018–22
Burruss Fellowship; Dann Fellowship; NASA–LCLUC Fieldwork Grant; CUT M.Sc. Fellowship	2016–22

Selected Presentations

Stanford–Hoover Institution, Heartland, NEUDC	2026
NBER EEE Spring Meeting, AAEA, Camp Resources, TWEEDS, Kansas State, IU Bloomington	2025
ASSA, AAEA, LEEP–Exeter, UW–Madison, UConn	2024
NEUDC, AERE, CES	2023
AERE, AAEA	2022

Teaching and Advising

Environmental Economics & Finance (IU)	2025–
Guest lectures: *LEAP Executive Program* (IU); *Economics of Water Policy* (UMass)	2023–25
PhD advising: Junying Tong, Dennis Vera (IU)	2023–

Service

Co-organizer, Social Cost of Water Pollution Workshop 2023–25

Referee: *Science*, *PNAS*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *World Development*, *World Development Perspectives*, *JAERE*, *Land Economics*, *Ecological Economics*, *Journal of Institutional Economics*. Grants: The British Academy. Conferences: AAEA, AERE, EEA.